National Center for PTSD
POSTTRAUMATIC STRESS DISORDER

The PTSD Checklist for *DSM-5* with Life Events Checklist for *DSM-5* and Criterion A

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Reference: Weathers, F. W., Litz, B. T., Keane, T. M., Palmieri, P. A., Marx, B. P., & Schnurr, P. P. (2013). *The PTSD Checklist for DSM-5 (PCL-5) – LEC-5 and Extended Criterion A* [Measurement instrument]. Available from http://www.ptsd.va.gov/

URL: http://www.ptsd.va.gov/professional/assessment/adult-sr/ptsd-checklist.asp

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PCL-5 with LEC-5 and Criterion A

Part 1

Instructions: Listed below are a number of difficult or stressful things that sometimes happen to people. For each event check one or more of the boxes to the right to indicate that: (a) it happened to you personally; (b) you witnessed it happen to someone else; (c) you learned about it happening to a close family member or close friend; (d) you were exposed to it as part of your job (for example, paramedic, police, military, or other first responder); (e) you're not sure if it fits; f) it doesn't apply to you; or decline to answer/disclose.

Be sure to consider your entire life (growing up as well as adulthood) as you go through the list of events.

Event	Happened to me	Witnessed it	Learned about it	Part of my job	Not sure	Doesn't apply	Decline to answer/ disclose
1. Natural disaster (for example, flood, hurricane, tornado, earthquake)							
2. Fire or explosion							
3. Transportation accident (for example, car accident, boat accident, train wreck, plane crash)	X	X					
4. Serious accident at work, home, or during recreational activity							
5. Exposure to toxic substance (for example, dangerous chemicals, radiation)							
6. Physical assault (for example, being attacked, hit, slapped, kicked, beaten up)							
7. Assault with a weapon (for example, being shot, stabbed, threatened with a knife, gun, bomb)							
Sexual assault (rape, attempted rape, made to perform any type of sexual act through force or threat of harm)							
9. Other unwanted or uncomfortable sexual experience							
10. Combat or exposure to a war-zone (in the military or as a civilian)							
11. Captivity (for example, being kidnapped, abducted, held hostage, prisoner of war)							
12. Life-threatening illness or injury							
13. Severe human suffering							
14. Sudden violent death (for example, homicide, suicide)		X					
15. Sudden accidental death		X					
16. Serious injury, harm, or death you caused to someone else							
17. Any other very stressful event or experience							

Part 2

A. If you checked anything for #17 in PART 1, briefly identify the event you were thinking of: _____

_____

B. If you have experienced more than one of the events in PART 1, think about the event you consider the worst event, which for this questionnaire means the event that currently bothers you the most. If you have experienced only one of the events in PART 1, use that one as the worst event. Please answer the following questions about the worst event (check all options that apply):

Briefly describe the worst event (for example, what happened, who was involved, etc.).
Witnessing a child struck and killed by a vehicle while I was driving (commuting).
Also a serious rear-end collision that totalled my vehicle.

[about 10 years ago]
How long ago did it happen? _____ (please estimate if you are not sure)

How did you experience it?

_____ It happened to me directly

__X__ I witnessed it

_____ I learned about it happening to a close family member or close friend

_____ I was repeatedly exposed to details about it as part of my job (for example, paramedic, police, military, or other first responder)

_____ Other, please describe _____

Was someone's life in danger?

_____ Yes, my life

__X__ Yes, someone else's life

_____ No

Was someone seriously injured or killed?

_____ Yes, I was seriously injured

__X__ Yes, someone else was seriously injured or killed

_____ No

Did it involve sexual violence? _____ Yes __X__ No

If the event involved the death of a close family member or close friend, was it due to some kind of accident or violence, or was it due to natural causes?

_____ Accident or violence

_____ Natural causes

__X__ Not applicable (The event did not involve the death of a close family member or close friend)

How many times altogether have you experienced a similar event as stressful or nearly as stressful as the worst event?

_____ Just once

__X__ More than once (please specify or estimate the total number of times you have had this experience _____)

Part 3

Below is a list of problems that people sometimes have in response to a very stressful experience. Keeping your worst event in mind, please read each problem carefully and then circle one of the numbers to the right to indicate how much you have been bothered by that problem in the past month.

In the past month, how much were you bothered by:	Not at all	A little bit	Moderately	Quite a bit	Extremely
1. Repeated, disturbing, and unwanted memories of the stressful experience?	0	(1)	2	3	4
2. Repeated, disturbing dreams of the stressful experience?	0	1	(2)	3	4
3. Suddenly feeling or acting as if the stressful experience were actually happening again (as if you were actually back there reliving it)?	(0)	1	2	3	4
4. Feeling very upset when something reminded you of the stressful experience?	0	1	(2)	3	4
5. Having strong physical reactions when something reminded you of the stressful experience (for example, heart pounding, trouble breathing, sweating)?	0	1	(2)	3	4
6. Avoiding memories, thoughts, or feelings related to the stressful experience?	0	(1)	2	3	4
7. Avoiding external reminders of the stressful experience (for example, people, places, conversations, activities, objects, or situations)?	0	1	(2)	3	4
8. Trouble remembering important parts of the stressful experience?	(0)	1	2	3	4
9. Having strong negative beliefs about yourself, other people, or the world (for example, having thoughts such as: I am bad, there is something seriously wrong with me, no one can be trusted, the world is completely dangerous)?	(0)	1	2	3	4
10. Blaming yourself or someone else for the stressful experience or what happened after it?	(0)	1	2	3	4
11. Having strong negative feelings such as fear, horror, anger, guilt, or shame?	0	(1)	2	3	4
12. Loss of interest in activities that you used to enjoy?	(0)	1	2	3	4
13. Feeling distant or cut off from other people?	(0)	1	2	3	4
14. Trouble experiencing positive feelings (for example, being unable to feel happiness or have loving feelings for people close to you)?	(0)	1	2	3	4
15. Irritable behavior, angry outbursts, or acting aggressively?	0	1	(2)	3	4
16. Taking too many risks or doing things that could cause you harm?	(0)	1	2	3	4
17. Being "superalert" or watchful or on guard?	0	1	(2)	3	4
18. Feeling jumpy or easily startled?	0	1	(2)	3	4
19. Having difficulty concentrating?	0	(1)	2	3	4
20. Trouble falling or staying asleep?	0	1	(2)	3	4